

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

INDIA-AFGHANISTAN - 1

MODULE - 25

INDIA AND AFGHANISTAN

- 1 India and Afghanistan have been shaped by history, culture and strong people to-people linkages
- 2 The relations have been built on the mutual trust and commonalities in traditional and cultural values
- 3 India has played a significant role in the reconstruction and rehabilitation of Afghanistan.

India-Afghanistan Bilateral relations can be divided into-

1. ANCIENT/HISTORICAL RELATIONS
2. POST-INDEPENDENCE RELATIONS
3. CONTEMPORARY RELATIONS



ANCIENT AND HISTORICAL TIES

1 Historical Relations between the people of India and Afghanistan have been dated back to the Indus Valley Civilisation.

2 Present-day Afghanistan was under the Mauryas. They had introduced Buddhism in the region.

3 Exchanges in the field of arts, culture, architecture, cuisine and language strengthened the cooperation. Afghan musicians were often trained in the Patiala Gharana.



POST INDEPENDENCE RELATIONS

- 1 In January 1950, India and Afghanistan signed a five-year Treaty of Friendship.
- 2 The treaty established "everlasting peace and friendship between the two Governments", and provided for establishment of diplomatic and consular posts in each other's territories
- 3 Afghanistan was under monarchical rule till 1973.
- 4 On July 19, 1973, India was the only South Asian nation to recognize the Soviet-backed Democratic Republic of Afghanistan and Soviet Union's military presence in the country in Afghan territories



POST INDEPENDENCE RELATIONS

- 5 Till 1989, India supported developmental activities in Afghanistan in the areas of industry, irrigation and hydroelectricity projects. It supported governments in the country until the rise of the Taliban in the 1990s.
- 6 In 1989 Soviet armed forces withdrew from Afghanistan and India continued to provide humanitarian aid.
- 7 The Taliban, with Pakistan's support came to power after a civil war. It affected India's relations with Afghanistan as India supported anti-Taliban Northern Alliance.
- 8 The 1999 hijacked Indian Airlines was suspected to be carried out by Taliban.
- 9 After the overthrow of the Taliban in 2001, India renewed ties with Afghanistan. Political leaders in Afghanistan, favourable to India further boosted Indo-Afghan relations



CONTEMPORARY RELATIONS

Contemporary relations between India and Afghanistan can be divided into-

1. Political
2. Strategic
3. Security
4. Economic and Commercial
5. Humanitarian Assistance
6. Capacity Building
7. People-to-people ties
8. Multilateral Cooperation



- 1** India believes that **democracy and development** will help bring regional stability in Afghanistan.
- 2** India has reiterated **India's commitment to extend full support to Afghanistan's** efforts for building a peaceful, united, prosperous, inclusive and democratic Afghanistan.
- 3** The large number of bilateral high-level visits from both sides display high-level political of engagement.
- 4** By helping rebuild a new Afghanistan, India strives for greater regional stability and hopes to counter Pakistan's influence in the country.



- 1** India signed an Agreement on Strategic Partnership with Afghanistan in 2011.
- This agreement shapes India's overall engagement with Afghanistan.
 - It envisages close political cooperation with a mechanism for regular consultations.
 - It seeks to launch joint initiatives on regional and international issues and to cooperate at the United Nations and other multinational fora.

- 2** India's Afghan policy is driven by many external factors
- Geographical constraints
 - Search for a transit route to Central Asia through Afghanistan and Iran
 - Troubled relationship with Pakistan
 - Growing threat of terrorism in India and Afghanistan



RUSSIA



NEW EUROPEAN LAND BRIDGE

TRANS-SIBERIAN RAILWAY

MOSCOW

BELARUS

KAZAKHISTAN

MONGOLIA

Black Sea

Caspian Sea

TURKEY

SYRIA

IRAQ

IRAN

AFGHANISTAN

PAKISTAN

CHINA

INDIA

EGYPT

SAUDI ARABIA

NEPAL

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

VIETNAM

East China S



- 1 Security cooperation between the two countries is intended to enhance their mutual efforts in the fight against terrorism, organised crime, narcotics trafficking and money laundering.
- 2 Both nations have developed strategic and military cooperation against Islamic militants
- 3 India donated three Mi-25 attack helicopters to Afghanistan as part of the bilateral strategic cooperation.
- 4 India agreed to help in the equipping and capacity building program for Afghan National Security Forces.
- 5 At present, more than half the country is in rural, mountainous areas and is controlled by the Taliban. The Islamic State has set up a base in eastern Afghanistan.
- 6 Countries like Russia, China and Iran fear that instability in Afghanistan may spill over to other countries.



TRADE

- 1 India is one of the largest markets for Afghan products. In 2018, Afghan exports to India amounted to \$740 million.
- 2 Many Indian companies are doing businesses in Afghanistan such as Gammon India, Spice Jet, Phoenix, APTECH, etc.

TRANSIT

- 1 The inauguration of the dedicated air cargo corridor in June 2017 between Kabul-Delhi and Kandahar-Delhi has provided a fresh impetus to bilateral trade.



TRANSIT

- 2 India has constructed over 2,500 miles of roads in Afghanistan.
- 3 The Iranian port provides easy access to the sea to Afghanistan and India has helped developed this route to allow both countries to engage in trade bypassing Pakistan.
- 4 India and Afghanistan signed a pact on vehicular movement to boost overland transit



INTERNATIONAL NORTH-SOUTH TRANSPORT CORRIDOR PROJECT

- 1** In 2000, India, Iran and Russia agreed to cooperate on the International North-South Transport Corridor project.
- 2** INSTC is a multi-modal connectivity project providing established accessibility to the landlocked regions of Central Asia and Russia and increase connectivity between India, Iran, Russia, landlocked Afghanistan and Central Asia and Europe.
- 3** It is hoped to provide security of travel and safety of goods and help in harmonization of transport policies. Economic development may partially minimize the radicalization in the region as well.
- 4** Russia's deteriorating relationship with the West has led India to identify items for exports to Russia that the latter has traditionally imported from the US or EU.



INTERNATIONAL NORTH-SOUTH TRANSPORT CORRIDOR PROJECT

IMPORTANCE OF INDIA

- 1 INSTC is an ideal start to project India as a global player. It will test India's financial backbone and can prove to be a 'game changer' for India's Eurasian policy.
- 2 INSTC is expected to be the second corridor after Chabahar Port to access resource Central Asia and its market. This can make Iran and Azerbaijan regional hubs.
- 3 INSTC will create regional supply chains, a 'consumer-producer network' across Eurasia, that will reverse the traditional model of East being a producer and West being a consumer



INTERNATIONAL NORTH-SOUTH TRANSPORT CORRIDOR PROJECT

IMPORTANCE OF INDIA

- 4 INSTC could cut down costs and time taken for transfer of goods from India to Russia and Europe
- 5 It is 30 percent cheaper in cost and 40 percent shorter in route. These cheaper costs are expected to boost the competitiveness of India's trade.
- 6 INSTC can provide an alternative to OBOR for India.



INTERNATIONAL NORTH-SOUTH TRANSPORT CORRIDOR PROJECT

I. CHALLENGES FACED BY INSTC

- 1 INSTC does not have an institutional mechanism to monitor the issues relating to implementation on the ground.
- 2 There is lack of funding for the corridor.
- 3 There are no common border crossing rules among the participating nations.
- 4 The region is threatened by radicalism and insurgency and this security problem adds to the cost of the project.



INTERNATIONAL NORTH-SOUTH TRANSPORT CORRIDOR PROJECT

II. ZARANJ DELARAM HIGHWAY

- 1 The Zaranj to Delaram highway is a 218 km road project in south western Afghanistan to facilitate movement of goods and services to the Iranian border and onward to the Chabahar port
- 2 It was inaugurated by the Afghan president and Indian External Affairs minister.
- 3 It will provide Afghanistan with another outlet to a seaport in Chabahar in Iran and facilitate its bilateral trade with India



INFRASTRUCTURE

India has agreed to implement some important new projects such as the

- 1 Construction of the Afghan parliament in Kabul
- 2 Construction of Salma dam power project, Afghan-India Friendship Dam in Herat province.
- 3 Shahtoot dam and drinking water project for Kabul
- 4 Road connectivity to Band-e-Amir in Bamyān province to promote tourism
- 5 Low cost housing for resettlement of returning Afghan refugees in Nangarhar province
- 6 A gypsum board manufacturing plant in Kabul



ENERGY

TAPI PIPELINE

- 1 Turkmenistan-Afghanistan-Pakistan-India Pipeline (TAPI), also known as Trans-Afghanistan Pipeline, is a natural gas pipeline being developed by the Asian Development Bank.
- 2 The pipeline will transport Caspian Sea natural gas from Turkmenistan through Afghanistan into Pakistan and then to India.
- 3 Proponents see it as a modern continuation of the silk route.



ENERGY

INDIA'S CONCERNS

1 India has concerns relating to the safety of the pipeline and safe transit of gas through restive areas in Afghanistan and Pakistan. India strongly feels that these key issues need to be addressed to make this a win-win project.

2 SAARC and SCO should encourage regional economic cooperation and completion of Chabahar will help Afghanistan in trade with other countries.



- 1 Since 2001, India has offered \$3 billion for Afghanistan's reconstruction, making it the largest regional donor to the country
- 2 India is the most favoured destination for most Afghan tourists, especially for medical tourism.
- 3 India supplies 100gms of fortified biscuits everyday to each of the nearly two million school children in 33 of the 34 provinces of Afghanistan under a school feeding program administers through the world food program.
- 4 India announced the gift of 2,50,000 metric tons of wheat to assist Afghanistan tide over its food shortage.
- 5 The Indian missions in the Afghanistan's five major cities are providing free medical consultations and medicine to over 30,000 Afghanis every month



TECHNICAL COOPERATION

- 1 India has established Agriculture University ANASTU in Kandahar in 2014.
- 2 India has built over 200 public and private schools and sponsors over 1000 scholarships for over 16,000 Afghan students.
- 3 India is running several programs for training and capacity-building for civil servants and police force in Afghanistan.
- 4 The MoU on Technical Cooperation on Police Training and Development is expected to expand its capacity building of Afghan troops to include policemen and security forces.



1 About 2500 Indians reside in Afghanistan. Most of the Indian diaspora are engaged as professionals in banks, IT firms, construction companies, hospitals, NGOs and telecom companies.

2 India has maintained an Afghan centric liberalized tourist visa and medical visa regime.

Sister City relations:

1. Kabul – New Delhi
2. Kandahar – Mumbai
3. Ajmer Sharif – Herat
4. Hyderabad – Jalalabad
5. Ahmedabad – Asadabad
6. State of Assam – Province of Helmand

The cities are connected through tourism, student and faculty exchange program.



1 In 2005, India proposed Afghanistan's membership in the South Asian Association for Regional Cooperation (SAARC).

2 In 2016, Afghanistan supported India's boycott of the SAARC summit hosted by Pakistan. This was a major diplomatic victory for India.

3 India, an observer in the Shanghai Cooperation Organization, has been pursuing better relations with Central Asian states for energy cooperation.

4 Afghanistan strongly supports India's membership of the UN Security Council and other groupings and hoped that it would back Afghanistan's entry into the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation (SCO)



KABUL CONFERENCE

THE KABUL PROCESS FOR PEACE & SECURITY COOPERATION

- 1 Kabul Process meeting is a gathering of 23 nations, the EU, UN and NATO
- 2 It is an Afghan-led and Afghan-owned inclusive peace process and is intended to discuss security and political issues in the country.
- 3 The purpose is to place the Afghan Government as the key driving force for achieving peace, with the support of regional and international partners.
- 4 The Government of Afghanistan had convened the first meeting of the Kabul Process for Peace and Security Cooperation on 6 June 2017 in Kabul.
- 5 It had invited states of the region along with key members of the international community.



HEART OF ASIA

- 1 The Heart of Asia (HoA) conference is a part of the Istanbul Process established in 2011 to provide a platform to discuss regional cooperation particularly encouraging security, political, and economic cooperation among Afghanistan and its neighbors.
- 2 The 6th edition Heart of Asia conference was held in Amritsar in December 2016.
- 3 The fourteen participating countries were Russia, China, India, Pakistan, Afghanistan, Iran, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyz Republic, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Saudi Arabia, UAE, Azerbaijan and Turkey.
- 4 The theme of the conference was “Addressing Challenges, Achieving Prosperity”.
- 5 The three big issues of the conference were:
 1. countering terrorism to create stability in Afghanistan
 2. providing Afghanistan connectivity to strengthen economic activity
 3. bringing development essential for its progress.



HEART OF ASIA

WHY AMRITSAR?

- 1 The choice of Amritsar was aligned with the PM Modi's policy to move international conferences out of the national capital and showcase other cities in India.
- 2 The location also supports the theme of connectivity, as Amritsar is a stop on the old Grand Trunk (GT) Road that connected Bangladesh to Peshawar, close to the border with Afghanistan.
- 3 The GT Road, was one of the main arteries of South Asia—for centuries linking the eastern and western regions of the Indian subcontinent—from Bangladesh through the vast Gangetic plains up to Peshawar and beyond.



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